Arsenale

User guide, version 1.1.0

Start

You need Node.js 20 or newer.

See it first. The demo is an invented company in a temporary folder. It never touches your data.

```
node bin/arsenale.cjs demo
```

Install. The installer asks before every change. Add `--dry-run` to see the plan.

Windows `powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1`

macOS, Linux `./install.sh`

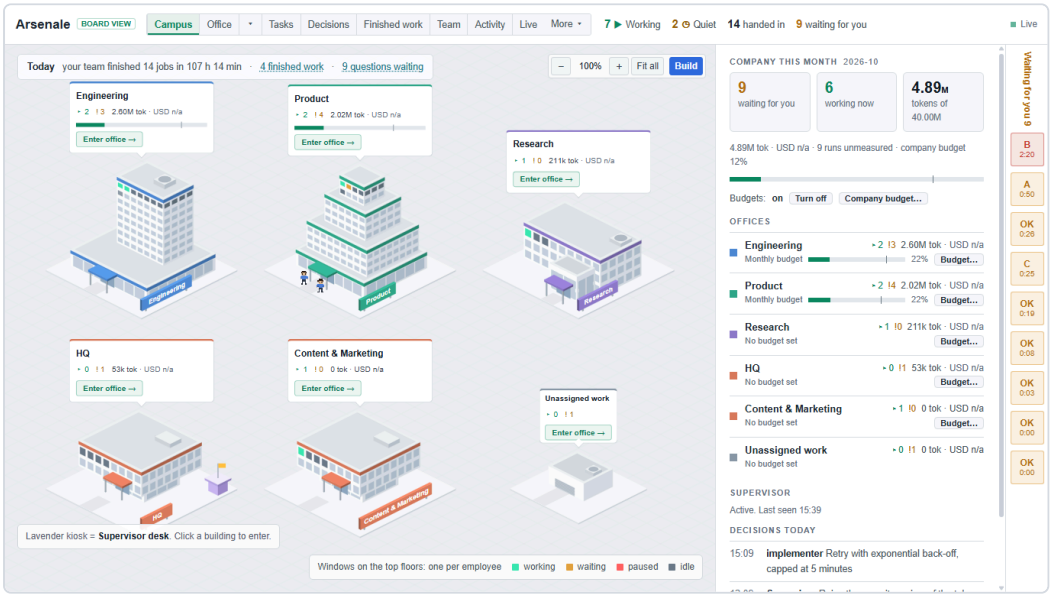
Run. `arsenale serve` opens `http://localhost:4310` in your browser. `arsenale open` opens it again.

Connect your tools. Open **Settings, Assistants**. Claude Desktop, Claude Code, Cursor, VS Code, Codex CLI, Gemini CLI and Aider each have a card with the exact command. Press **Test**. It turns green when the tool says hello.

> Arsenale only watches. It never starts or stops your assistants.

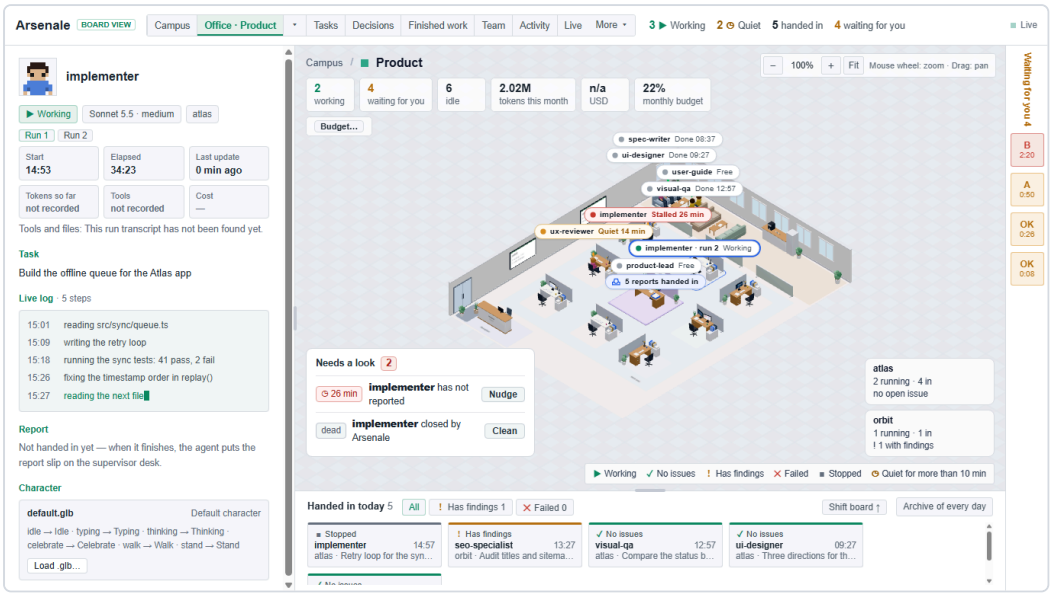
Campus

One building per office. Click a building to go in. **Build** lets you place, move, rotate and archive buildings.



Office

People sit at their desks and show what they are doing. A small pill marks a person who is quiet, stalled or dead. The **Needs a look** box lists them. **Nudge** asks your supervisor to check the run. **Clean** hides a closed run; its log stays.

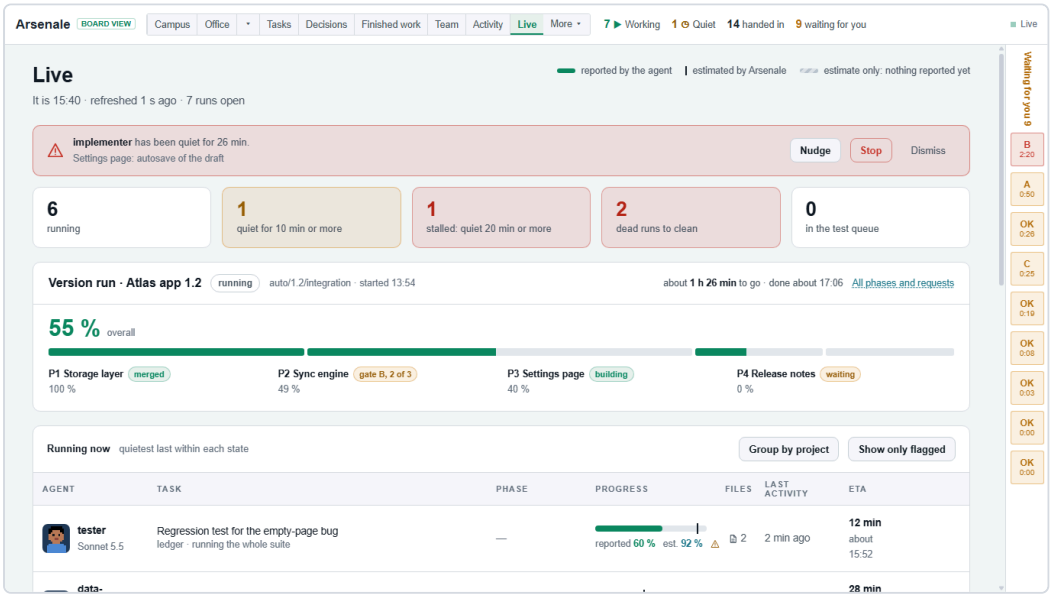


Live

Every run that is working now: the step, a percent, files changed, last activity, time so far and time left. The percent is what the agent reports. Without one, Arsenale estimates it and marks it "est.".

A run quiet for 10 minutes turns amber. At the stall limit (20 minutes) it turns red and a bar appears with **Nudge** and **Stop**. Stop only asks your supervisor to end the run.

Live also shows the test queue and unfinished work.



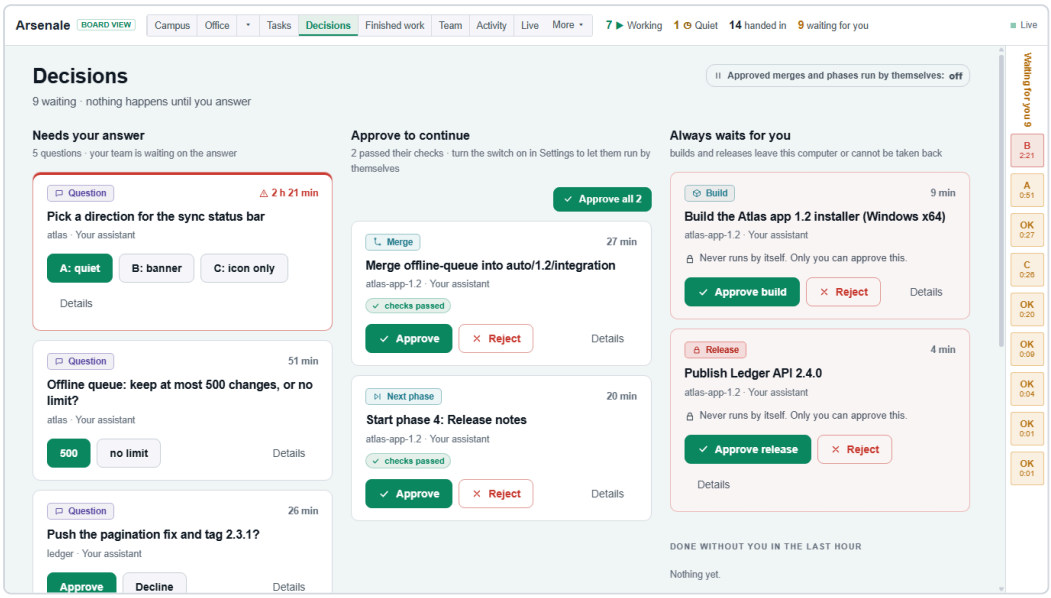
Decisions

Every waiting question and approval, in three columns.

- **Needs your answer.** Questions from your team.
- **Approve to continue.** A merge or a next phase. **Approve all** answers them together.
- **Always waits for you.** Builds and releases.

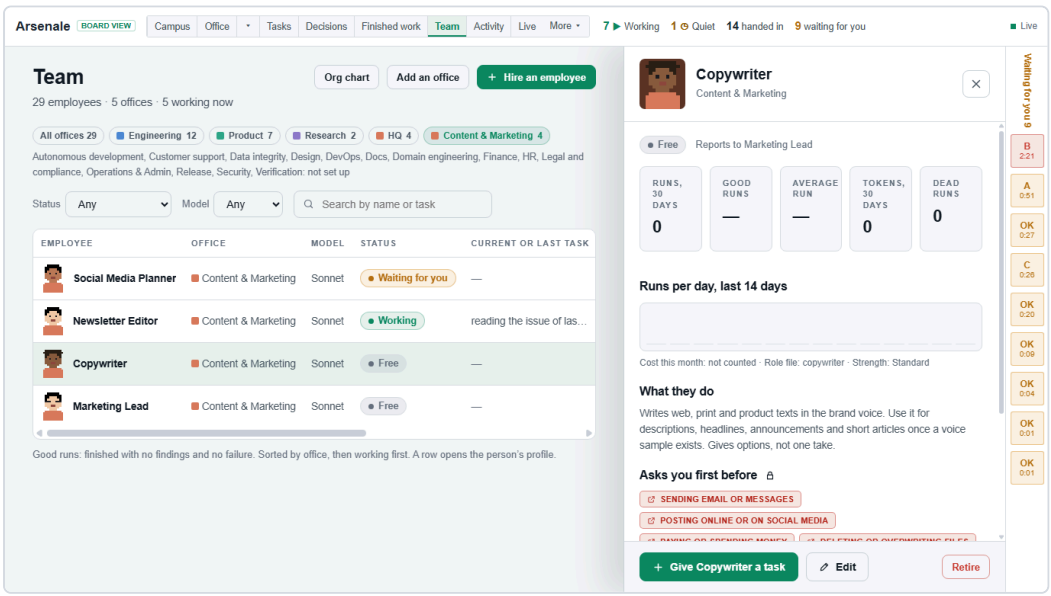
Details shows the evidence. Under the columns, **Done without you** lists what ran by itself in the last hour. **Undo** works once, for 10 minutes.

The switch at the top right, **Approved merges and phases run by themselves**, is off by default. Set it in Settings, Decisions.



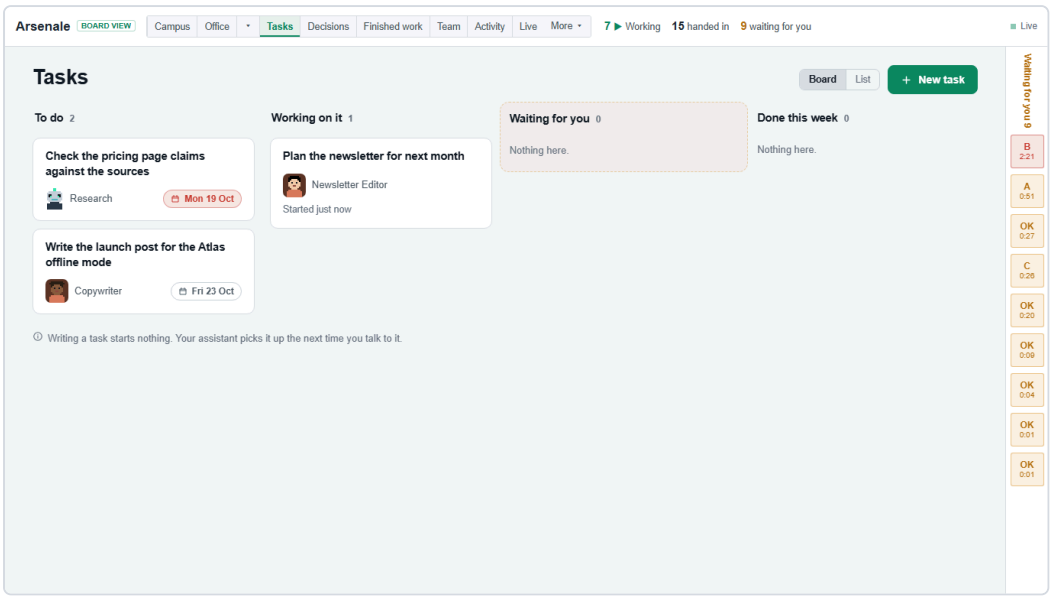
Team

Everyone, grouped by office: status, current task, runs today, last active. Search, or filter by office or status. A row opens the profile. **New desk** hires someone in plain words.



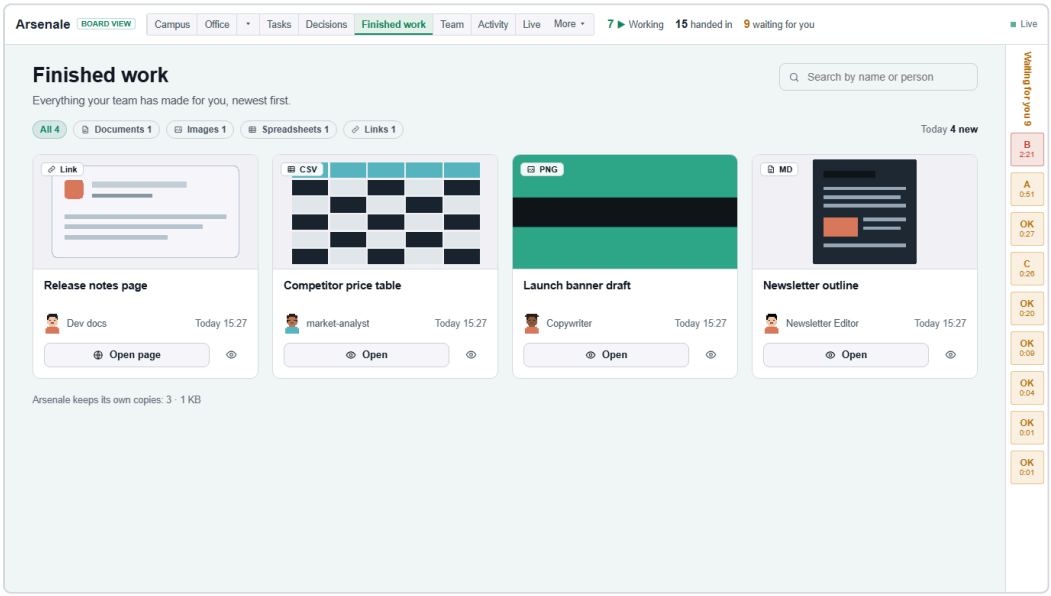
Tasks

A board: To do, Working on it, Waiting for you, Done this week. Or a list. **New task** takes what you need, who should do it and when. Writing a task starts nothing: your assistant picks it up the next time you talk to it.



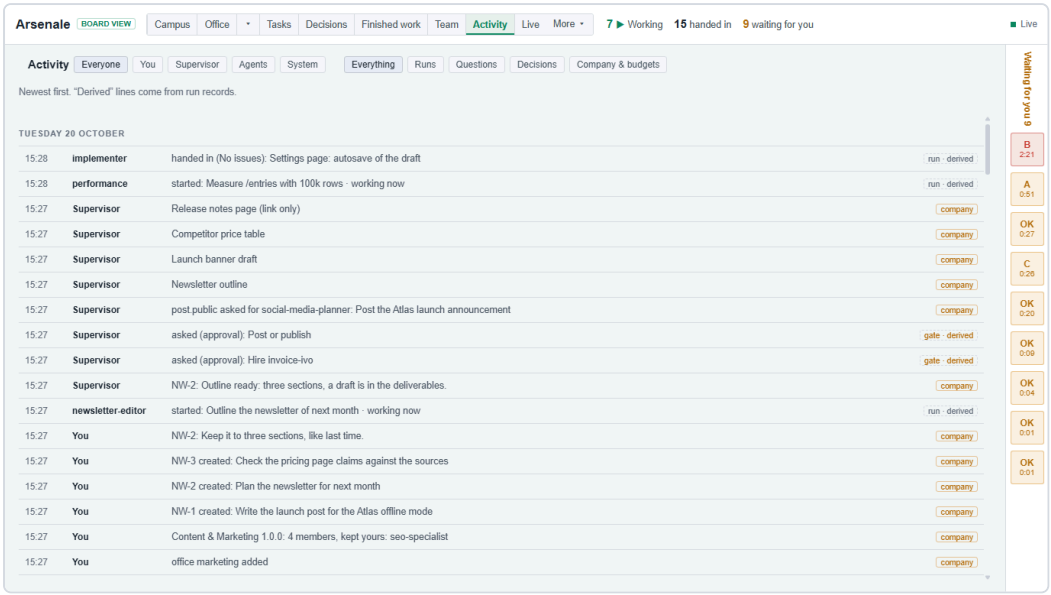
Finished work

Documents, images, spreadsheets and links your team handed in. Search by name or person. Previews come from Arsenale's own copies.



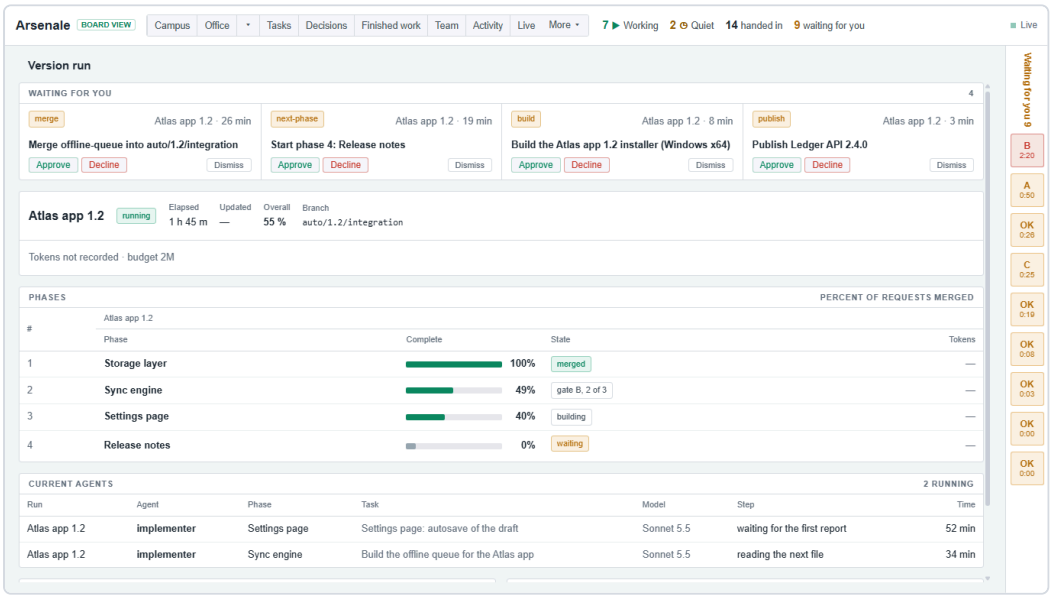
Activity

Who did what and when, grouped by day. Filter it. Closed and stopped runs stay here; nothing is deleted.



Version run

For an autonomous run of a version: its phases, overall percent, agents, token budget and owner gates. Open it with **All phases and requests** on Live.

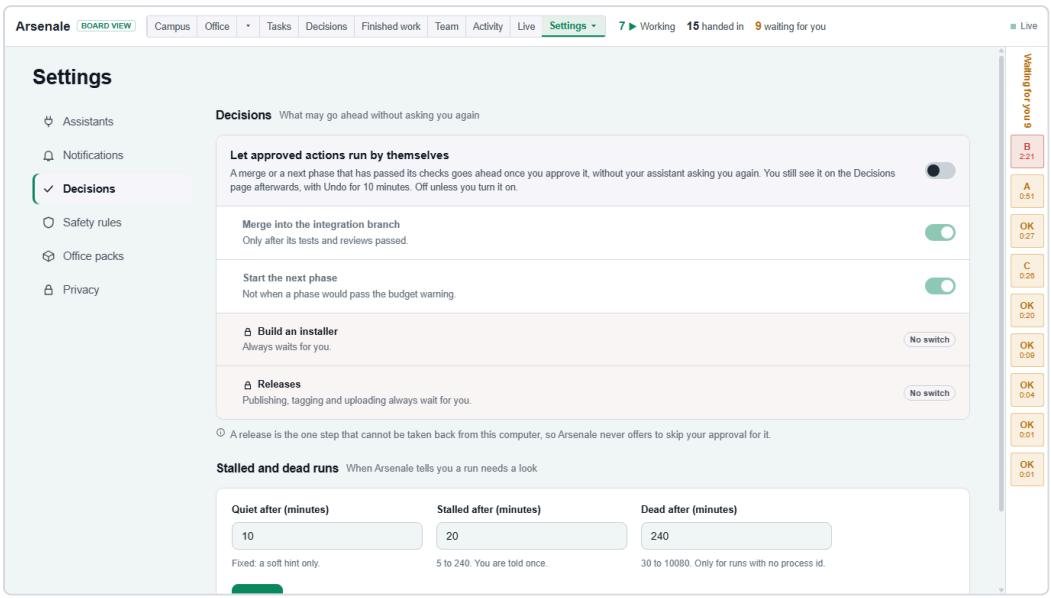


Gate history

Under **More**. A timeline of who decided what.

Settings

- **Assistants.** Connect a tool in three steps, with a Test button.
- **Notifications.** Desktop and phone. See the next section.
- **Decisions.** The auto-run switch, one switch each for merges and next phases, and the limits for a quiet, stalled and dead run.
- **Safety rules.** See Safety.
- **Office packs.** Add a ready-made office, or remove one. Your own files are kept.
- **Privacy.** Everything stays on this computer. No account, no tracking.



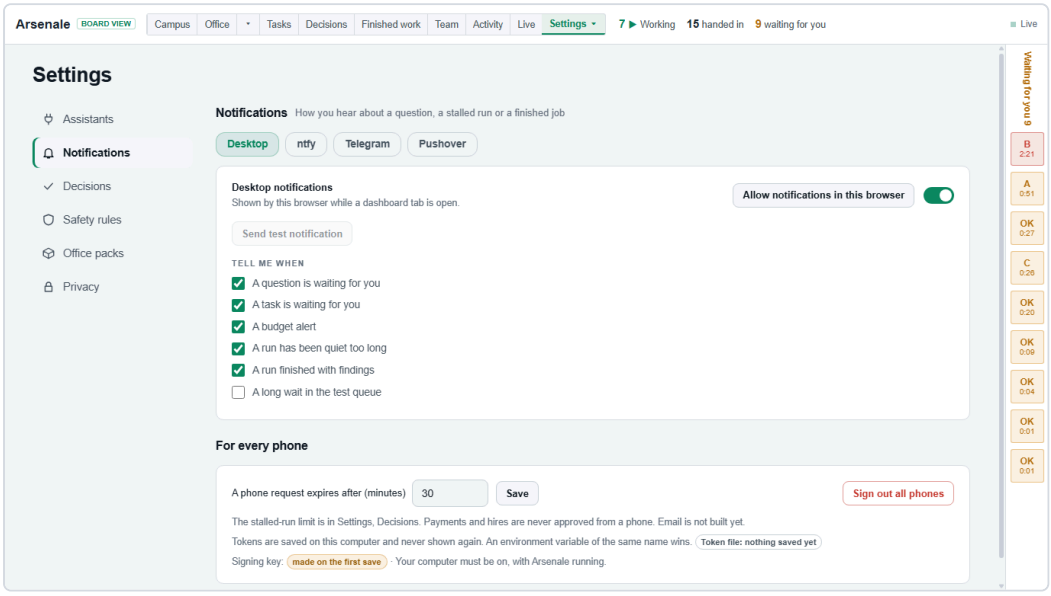
Phone notifications

Settings, Notifications has a tab each for Desktop, ntfy, Telegram and Pushover.

1. Fill in the channel. Tokens are saved in a file only you can read and are never shown again.
2. Press **Save**, then **Send test**.
3. When the test arrives, the channel's switch can go on. It stays off until a test has arrived.

Change a server, topic or token and the channel switches off until the next test arrives. Each channel has its own list of events.

By default a phone message says only that something is waiting. Turn on details to include the question; that shows its text to the service. ntfy and Telegram can carry Approve and Reject. Pushover only notifies. Arsenale must be running on your computer to send.

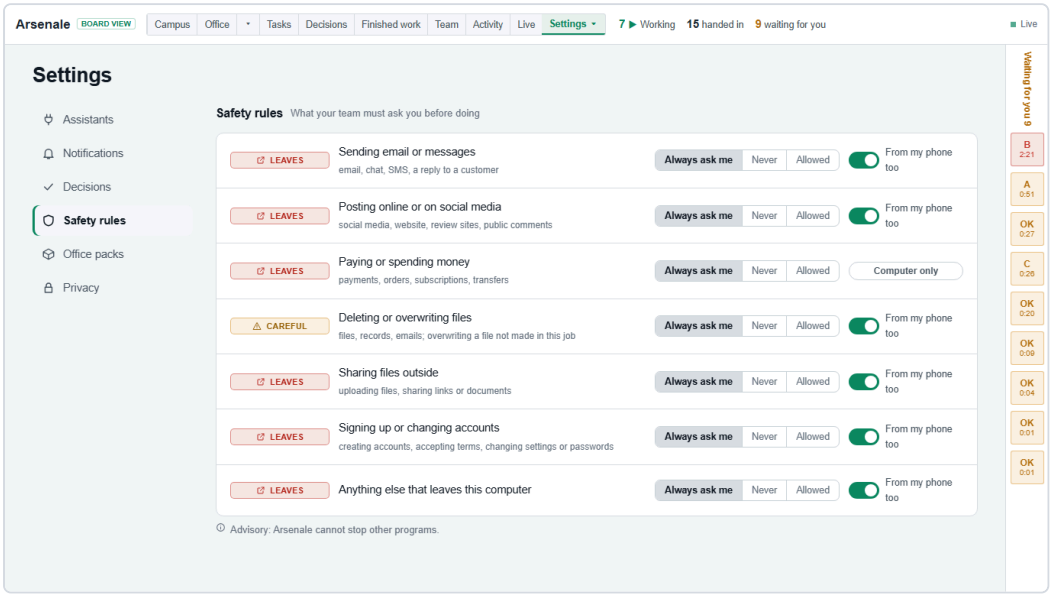


Safety

Builds and releases always wait for you. Building, tagging, publishing or uploading a release is never approved by the auto-run switch and never gets a phone button. Payments and hires are not approved from a phone either.

Settings, Safety rules sets, for each kind of action that leaves your computer, whether it is allowed, must ask you first (the default), or is never allowed.

> These rules are advisory. Arsenale asks your assistant to check and records what happened; it cannot block a tool inside another program.



The test queue

Only one full test suite should run on a machine at a time. A builder runs it like this:

```
arsenale testq run --run <run id> -- <command>
```

It waits its turn, runs the command and exits with its result. `arsenale testq status` shows who holds the suite and who waits. `arsenale testq leave --run <run id>` leaves the queue. A run that waits is not counted as quiet. Live shows the same queue.

After a restart

Run `arsenale resume-scan` at the start of a session. It finds runs that ended without finishing and left changes behind. Live lists them under unfinished work.

- **Resume** sends the stored brief to your supervisor's inbox. It starts nothing.
- **Dismiss** hides the item. Nothing in the worktree is deleted.